



Baidu aces GLUE competition

Baidu's ERNIE AI system is the first to surpass the score of 90 on the GLUE AI benchmark <https://dgit.in/jan20-51>



Speed over safety

A report by BuzzFeed News and ProPublica alleges that Amazon prioritises speed over public safety <https://dgit.in/jan20-52>

Moto G8 Plus

The return of the Moto G series

After an overpriced Moto G7 Plus, Moto G8 Plus marks the return of the Moto G-lineup in the lower mid-range segment. But is that enough to compete against the likes of Realme 5 Pro, Samsung Galaxy M30s and Redmi Note 8 Pro? Let's find out.

Display and Audio

The Moto G8 Plus features a 6.3-inch 18:9 Full HD+ IPS LCD display. The brightness maxes out at 500 nits, which is below average for a sub-₹15,000 device based on our testing. That being said, the content on the screen was easily visible even under direct sunlight.

Speaker output on the Moto G8 Plus is loud and clear. The company includes a range of Dolby enhancements that you can toggle on or off. When left on 'Auto mode', the Dolby settings adjust to the scenario, whether it be while watching movies or while playing music. You can always manually tinker with the bass, mids, and vocals depending on your style of listening.

Overall, with excellent speakers and a crisp display, the Moto G8 Plus is one of the best in the range.

Camera

Moto G8 Plus sports a 48 MP main sensor with an f/1.7 aperture + a 16 MP ultrawide Action camera with an f/2.2 aperture + a 5 MP depth sensor with an f/2.2 aperture. The triple rear camera setup is accompanied by an autofocus module. However, more doesn't necessarily mean better. The image quality is rather average. The phone saves 12 MP oversampled photos by default. Also, you cannot click pictures at the full 48MP resolution. When shooting close subjects, the de-



Price
₹13,999



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vice focuses swiftly. It captures a decent amount of details. The

images are sharp, colours are vivid and the images look quite good.

Overall, the camera tends to highlight blue tones. This makes the image look much cooler than it is supposed to be.

The dynamic range, as you can make out from the samples, isn't great either. It blows out highlights. As for portrait shots, the depth sensor does a good job of detecting edges around our subject and blurring backgrounds.

Shooting in low light environments is a hit and a miss with the Night Vision turned on. However, it doesn't make much of a difference in low light shots. Sometimes, the image processing makes an image look worse with Night Vision turned on than it was with Night Vision turned off. The low light shots have had muddy details.

Surprisingly, there is a wide-angle camera on the Moto G8 Plus, but it

cannot take wide-angle photos. It is Motorola's Action Cam, which only allows you to shoot videos. The video quality is good and electronic stabilisation works fine in daylight.

Coming to the front camera, it lets you capture selfies at full 25MP resolution or oversampled to 6MP. Selfies look decent during the day time. The camera manages to capture good colours and details. The low light quality would be rated average with weak details, and ample noise.

Performance

In our benchmark tests, the Moto G8 Plus performed fine. It scored 1,42,599 on AnTuTu 7.0, which is less than the competitors. For reference, Redmi Note 8 Pro scored 2,22,904, in the same test. However, it was more than the Galaxy M30s. The Moto G8 Plus scored 1760 in 3D Mark Sling Shot.

As for gaming, Asphalt 9 ran at a median frame rate of 25 frames per second with 44 percent stability. In contrast, PUBG Mobile ran at a median frame rate of 21 frames per second with 98 percent stability.

Battery

Moto G8 Plus packs a 4000mAh battery and the battery life on this phone is excellent. It lasted for more than 20 hours - that's more than the average of the sub-₹15,000 phones we have tested thus far. The Moto G8 Plus ships with a 15W USB-C charger in the box, which charges the battery from zero to 100 percent in around 2 hours.

Bottom Line

The Moto G8 Plus is excellent when it comes to media consumption, battery life and performance. The camera performance of the Moto G8 Plus is just a little above average at best.

—Prakhar Khanna

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Snapdragon SDM665 | GPU: Adreno 610 | DISPLAY: LTPS IPS capacitive screen | ANDROID: 9.0 Pie | STORAGE: 64 GB | RAM: 4 GB | CAMERA: 48 MP, f/1.7 + 16 MP, f/2.2 + 5 MP, f/2.2 | BATTERY: 4000 mAh | FAST CHARGING: 15 W | WARRANTY: 1 year.

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